Jelle Gortemaker

Van: webmaster-wbk-citg
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Onderwerp: HE Team Update
Bijlagen: Internal pre selection form Tulip Fund Second Round.docx

Dear colleagues,

Here is the team update for this week.

This week will be Dijana's last week at TU Delft. There will be an opportunity to say goodbye and have a coffee and cake on Friday from 12:15-13:00, in the hallway before 3.73.1.

❖ **GENERAL ANNOUNCEMENTS**

- **Temporary section heads**: From 19 February until 29 May, Hayo Hendrikse will temporarily take over the role as EFM section head from Ton van den Bremer. Furthermore, Maria Pregnolato will temporarily take over Oswaldo Morales Napoles as head of HSFR, starting 20 January until 20 February.
- **HE Strategy Session 4**: On Thursday, January 29th, the 4th HE Strategy Session will take place in Vakwerkhuis. Please let us know your availability by responding to the Outlook invitation mail. We hope to see many of you again.
- **Tulip fund**: In summer 2025, NWO has published the Tulip Fund call for proposals. The boards of each research organisation in the Netherlands may nominate a maximum of two top researchers who wish to continue their work in the Netherlands due to the growing threats to academic freedom. Our faculty may still submit one candidate. Submissions must be sent in by the dean (or accompanied by support of the dean) to Marion Stenneke (m.stenneke@tudelft.nl), using the attached format. Deadline is February 9th 2026.
- **Vacancy Assistant Professor Offshore Engineering**: Please note the following vacancy Assistant Professor in Integrated Dynamics of Offshore Wind Structures.

❖ **TOPIC OF THE WEEK – LEAVE HOURS**

Please be aware of the procedure regarding working internationally and make sure you make the necessary requests well in time. You can find more information here.

❖ **PERSONNEL DEVELOPMENTS**

- **Welcome new colleagues!**

- Mustafa Erdogan

Mustafa obtained his bachelor's and master's degrees in civil engineering from Middle East Technical University in Ankara, Turkey. After completing his bachelor's studies, he worked for three years as a Coastal Design Engineer at a private company in Turkey. During his master's research, he conducted numerical experiments using the OpenFOAM CFD library to develop a design approach for wave-induced forces on berm-breakwater crown walls. In November 2025, he began his PhD at TU Delft in the Marine Renewable Energies Lab under the Offshore Engineering Section, where he focuses on the impacts of climate change on wave energy resources in European seas.

- Sricharan Dakka

Hi, I'm Dakka, and I come from India. I studied Master's in Structural Engineering at TU Delft. Before that, I worked as a bridge design engineer in Mumbai. I started my PhD at the Offshore section of the Hydraulic Engineering department on December 1st. My topic is about the decommissioning of offshore monopiles. Feel free to swing by Room 3.53 to discuss anything ranging from Indian food to differential equations. I like cooking, calligraphy, listening to BGM and meeting new people. Have a nice day!

- Jeancarlo M. Fajardo Urbina

Hi, I am Jeancarlo M. Fajardo Urbina, a postdoctoral researcher who started on 1 January 2026. My current work focuses on the impact of offshore wind farms on stratification, circulation, and mixing in the North Sea. In the second half of 2025, I was a postdoctoral researcher at the University of the Balearic Islands (Spain), where my research focused on storm surge extremes in the mid-latitudes of the Northern Hemisphere. Earlier in 2025, I defended my PhD thesis at Eindhoven University of Technology, where I investigated the long-term variability of circulation and transport in the Dutch Wadden Sea using both Eulerian and Lagrangian numerical models.
In my free time, I enjoy traveling, playing board and card games, and spending time with friends.
I look forward to meeting you all!

Met vriendelijke groet / Kind regards,

Elske, Dijana & Jelle

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